PLUGIN SHOOTOUT

AUDIO

V1 / README

MAX FOR LIVE

BY CALUM VAUGHAN

SURVIVAL OF THE FITTEST

PluginShootout started with amp simulations: lots of amps and presets to compare, and too much time spent switching plugins on and off. It works with **any audio effects**, letting you A/B test huge pools of candidates without manually bypassing each one.

It is survival of the fittest for your effects chain. Step through the candidates one at a time, move the favourites to the front and delete the ones that do not fit. Repeat until you have a shortlist, or a winner.

Use it to find an unexpected sound, choose an amp tone or compare the subtleties of EQs and compressors. The same workflow suits **creative exploration and critical listening**.

SETUP

Load the .amxd with Max for Live available. Place PluginShootout before your comparison effects in the same Audio Effect Rack chain.



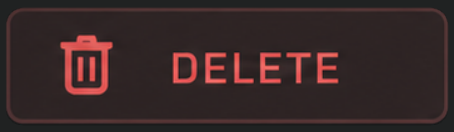




Step through the candidates. The selected effect is enabled; the other comparison effects are disabled. Keep your source audio playing while you compare.



Move the selected effect to the front of the comparison order. Selection stays at its original position so you can carry on through the candidates.



Remove the selected effect from the chain. The replacement at that position becomes the next selection when one is available.



Open or close the selected plugin's editor. Auto-Reveal GUIs can do this as you switch.

LISTENING TO

The name of the selected candidate. Track, Group and Chain labels show which instance and rack context you are working in.

PLUGIN SHOOTOUT

POPUP

FLOATING CONTROLS



The same four comparison controls in a floating window, with the current track, group, chain and effect shown above them.

Drag the hand to move it. Click **X** to close it, or triple-click the drag handle.

OPTIONS / POPUP SIZE

100% | 150% | 200%

POPUP / IN ABLETON LIVE

OPTIONS

Expand Options for window controls, appearance settings, mapping and help.

FUNCTIONS

Auto-Reveal GUIs
Show the selected plugin's editor when switching.

Open / Close All Windows
Open or close the plugin editors managed by this instance.

Turn Off Others
Disable the other comparison candidates.

Collapse Devices
Fold the controlled devices in Live's device view.

APPEARANCE / HELP

Background & text colour
Set the interface colours with the two pickers.

Randomize BGs
Generate new background colours.

Help + Support
Open the built-in help.

Max Debug Window
Open the Max console to view diagnostic messages.

CONTROLLER MAPPING

Options > Mapping: assign these targets with Live's MIDI or Key Map.

PREVIOUS | NEXT | MOVE TO FRONT | DELETE

No enable switch is needed. Hiding the panel keeps the assignments.

Mapped actions do not support Undo/Redo. Changes may remain in Undo history. Use the ordinary mouse buttons when you need normal Undo/Redo.

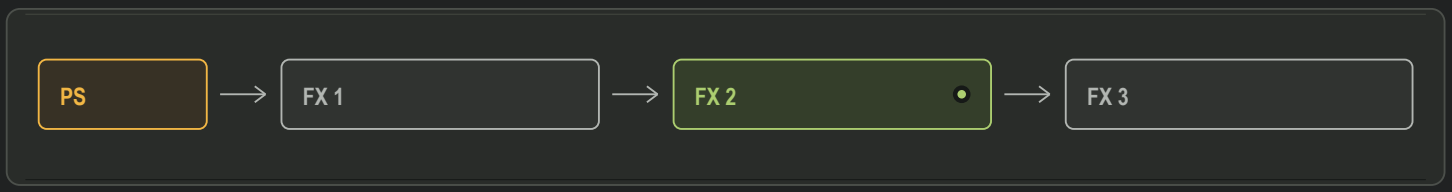
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USE CASES

Compare single effects, build combinations, or put a shootout inside another shootout. PS = PluginShootout. Boxes marked RACK contain a complete effect chain.

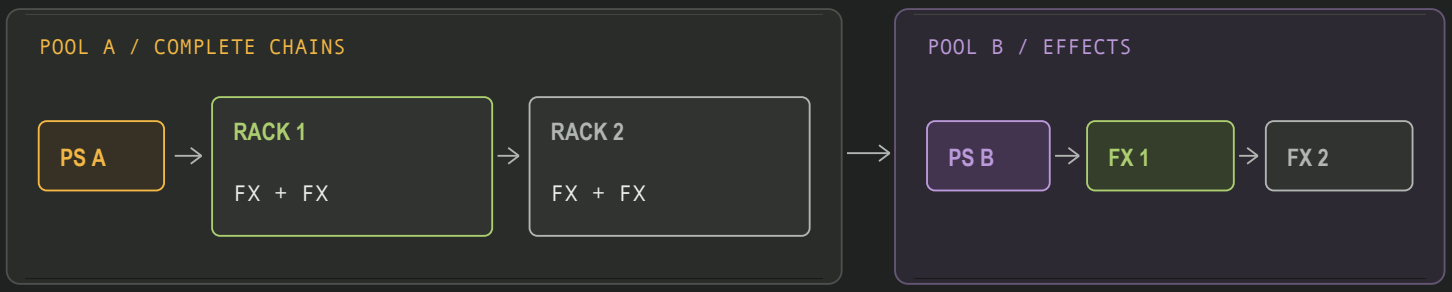
1 SIMPLE / ONE POOL OF EFFECTS

One PS followed by your candidates. Compare amp sims, EQs, compressors or different presets of the same effect. Only one candidate in that pool is selected at a time.



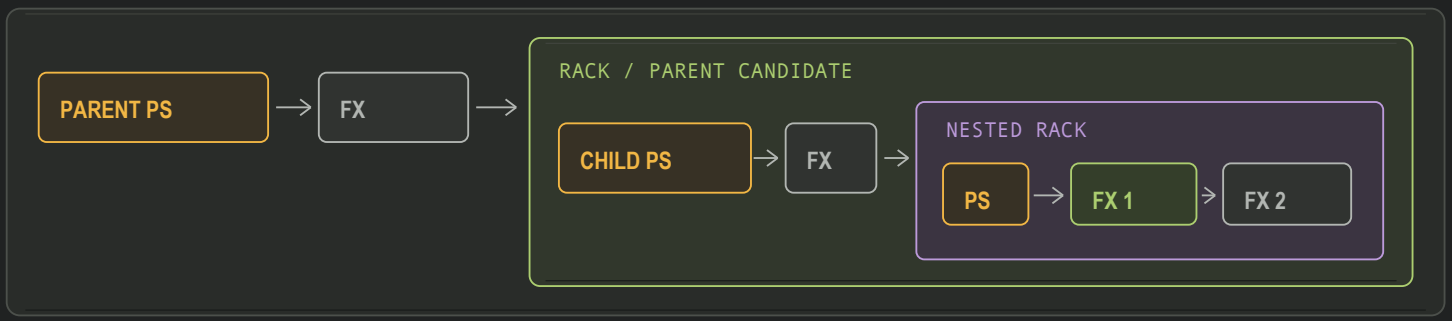
2 MULTIPLE / BUILD A COMPLETE SOUND

Put several PS instances on one track, each before its own pool. Make a separate selection in each pool to build the combined sound. To audition several effects together as one candidate, put them inside a rack.



3 NESTING / A SHOOTOUT INSIDE A SHOOTOUT

A parent PS can compare ordinary devices and racks containing their own PS. The parent selects the outer candidate; each child PS selects within its own chain. Repeat the arrangement inside another rack to build deeper comparisons.



What each PS controls: devices to its right at the same level, up to the next PS or the end of that track or rack chain. A rack is one candidate at the parent level: Move to Front or Delete acts on the whole rack. Use its child PS to work on the candidates inside.

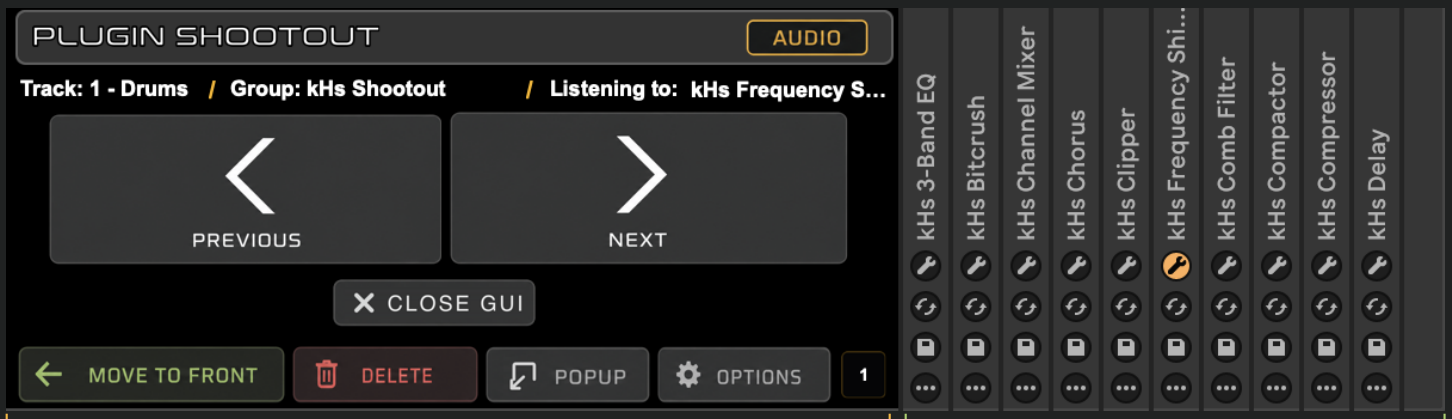
GO DEEPER

Nest racks inside racks to compare at different levels: a parent PS chooses the whole chain, a child compares variations, and another child refines one part. Build combinations, keep alternatives organised and narrow down each choice without rebuilding the setup.

THE SETUPS IN ABLETON LIVE

The same three arrangements in Live. The annotations show controllers and their candidate groups. Any audio effects can fill these positions.

1 SIMPLE / ONE PS, ONE POOL



PLUGINSHOOTOUT — COMPARISON EFFECTS

One PS controls the effects to its right. Each folded device is a separate candidate; the plugin names and effect types do not change how the comparison works.

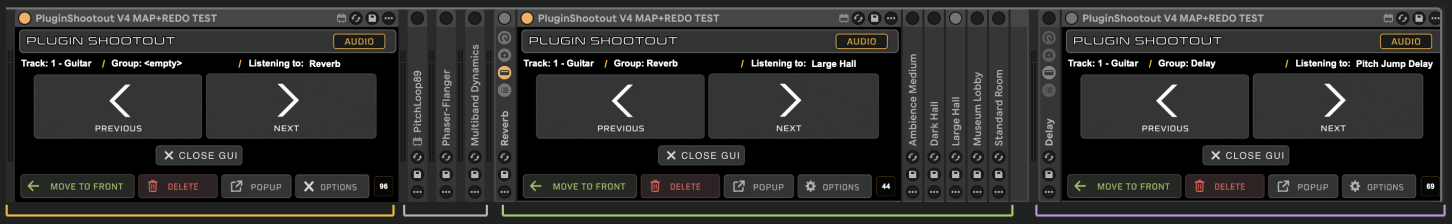
2 MULTIPLE / INDEPENDENT GROUPS



GROUP A / PS + CANDIDATES — GROUP B / PS + CANDIDATES

Each rack contains its own PS and candidate pool. The two groups sit on the same track: changing the choice in one group leaves the other group independent. Combine their selections to build a complete effects chain.

3 NESTING / PARENT + CHILD CONTROLLERS



PARENT PS — FX — RACK A / CHILD PS — RACK B / CHILD PS

PARENT CANDIDATES: INDIVIDUAL EFFECTS + WHOLE RACKS

Each child PS controls the candidates inside its own rack.